



Photograph Sandip Patil

Every month, *Digit* will carry a caption for a photo. Come up with something funnier, and beat the *Digit* team at their own game! Entries accepted by the 15th of this month.

Beat That!

Digit Caption
"Slick Calling!"

Last Month's Winner!

Anand Gupta,
Raigad, Maharashtra

"INPUT INSIDE, OUTPUT OUTSIDE!"



E-mail your caption with the subject "Beat That", and your postal address, to beatthat@thinkdigit.com and win

Essential ASP.NET
by Ted Pattison
Published by
Pearson Education,
Delhi



OpenOffice.org will attempt to break Microsoft's stranglehold on the business software segment. Sun's CEO Scott McNealy said, "Working with Google will make our technologies available more broadly, increase options for

users, lower barriers and expand participation worldwide."

Though it's not certain that the change in the stock markets directly afterwards was caused by this announcement, it's interesting to note that

Microsoft shares fell by a little while Google's

fell the highest, with only Sun seeing a marginal rise.

The bourses apart, nothing else seemed to indicate the beginnings of a ground-breaking story. This was perhaps due to the lack of details given by Sun and Google—there's no fixed date for the launch of this service, neither is there any clarity on whether this will be yet another Google service.

What we do know, however, is that the agreement gives Google the rights to further develop Sun's products.

If anything, this is the condition in the agreement that could worry Microsoft. After all, as we've seen with services such as Gmail, its world-renowned search technology and its Desktop Search application, Google builds great services and applications that are really easy for almost anyone to use. A Google-developed version of OpenOffice.org might just threaten MS Office enough to bring down prices a little, or actually make a dent in MS Office's business holdings.

Though we have no option but to wait and watch, as of yet, one thing's certain: life as an end-user of technology products and services is only going to get better!

YET ANOTHER FORMAT

The Memory Mess

You guessed it—another proprietary memory card format! As if we didn't have enough, Sony, in collaboration with SanDisk, have launched the Memory Stick Micro, a compact flash memory card that's just 1.5 x 1.25 x 0.12 cm (l x b x d) in dimensions.

The card has a whopping 32 GB theoretical data capacity—with the operative word being "theoretical", though even a quarter of that would meet with no complaints! The cards can support data transfers of a little over 150 Mbps—not bad at all.

The Memory Stick Micro

